

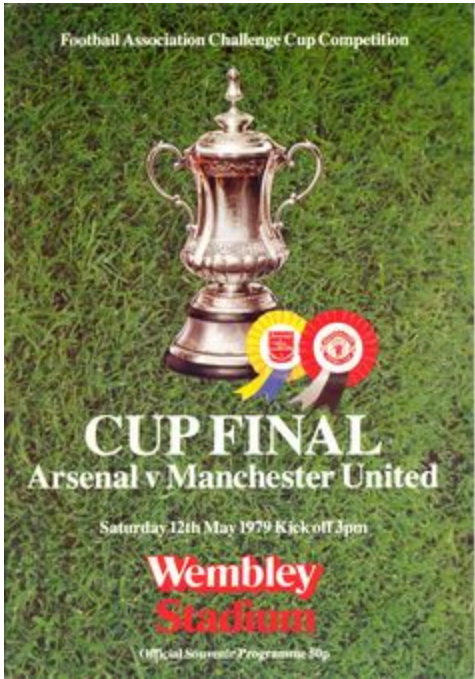
1979 FA Cup final

The **1979 FA Cup final** was a football match played on 12 May 1979 at Wembley Stadium. The match was contested by Arsenal and Manchester United. It is regarded as one of the greatest-ever finishes in an FA Cup final.^{[1][2]} For over 85 minutes the game had been unremarkable, with Arsenal taking a 2–0 half time lead through goals from Brian Talbot and Frank Stapleton. In the 86th minute, however, Gordon McQueen scored following a set-piece, and two minutes later Sammy McIlroy dribbled past two Arsenal players to score a dramatic equaliser. With the game poised for extra time, United's celebrations proved short-lived, as Alan Sunderland scored a last-minute winner, making the final result Arsenal 3–2 Manchester United. This match is often referred to as the "Five-minute Final".

The 1979 FA Cup was the only major trophy that Arsenal won during the seven-year management of Terry Neill, who was appointed in 1976 after Bertie Mee's retirement. He was dismissed in 1983.

It was also the only cup final that Manchester United reached under the management of Dave Sexton, who had been appointed as manager in 1977 and remained there until 1981 when he was sacked having failed to bring a major trophy to the club.

1979 FA Cup final



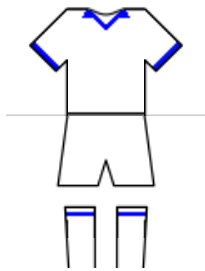
Match programme cover

Event	1978–79 FA Cup	
	<u>Arsenal</u>	<u>Manchester United</u>
	3	2
Date	12 May 1979	
Venue	<u>Wembley Stadium</u> , London	
Referee	<u>Ron Challis</u> (Kent)	
Attendance	99,219	

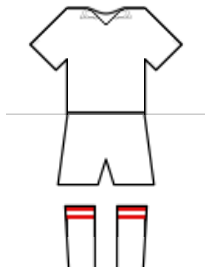
Match details

12 May 1979	<u>Arsenal</u>	3–2	<u>Manchester United</u>	Wembley, London Attendance: 99,219 Referee: <u>Ron Challis</u> (Kent)
	<u>Talbot</u> ⚽ 12' <u>Stapleton</u> ⚽ 43' <u>Sunderland</u> ⚽ 89'	Report (https://archive.today/20080906174608/http://www.thefa.com/TheFACup/TheFACup/NewsAndFeatures/Postings/)	<u>McQueen</u> ⚽ 86' <u>McIlroy</u> ⚽ 88'	

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htm)

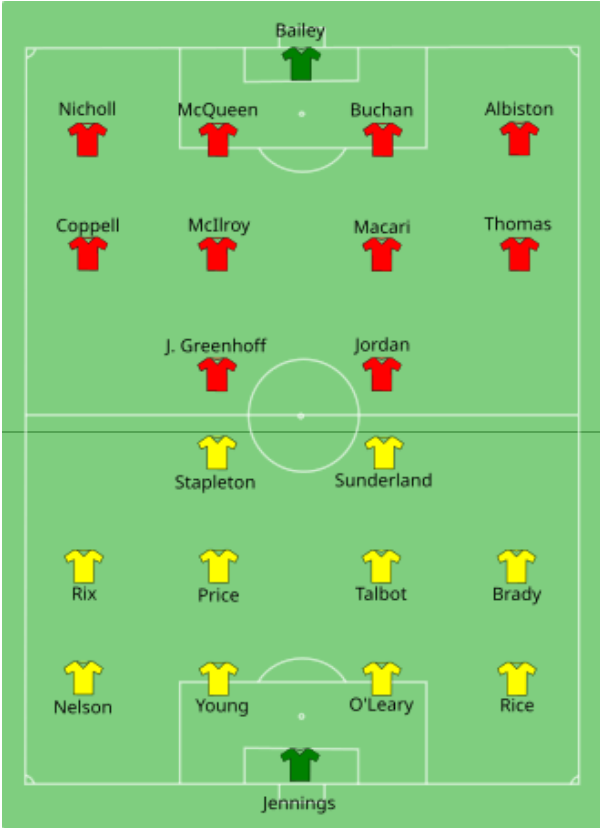


Arsenal



Manchester
United

- GK 1 Pat Jennings
RB 2 Pat Rice (c)
LB 3 Sammy Nelson
CM 4 Brian Talbot
CB 5 David O'Leary
CB 6 Willie Young
RM 7 Liam Brady
CF 8 Alan Sunderland
CF 9 Frank Stapleton
CM 10 David Price 83'
LM 11 Graham Rix
Substitute:
DF 12 Steve Walford 83'
Manager:
 Terry Neill



- GK 1 Gary Bailey
RB 2 Jimmy Nicholl
LB 3 Arthur Albiston
CM 4 Sammy McIlroy
CB 5 Gordon McQueen
CB 6 Martin Buchan (c)
RM 7 Steve Coppel
CF 8 Jimmy Greenhoff
CF 9 Joe Jordan
CM 10 Lou Macari
LM 11 Mickey Thomas
Substitute:
DF 12 Brian Greenhoff
Manager:
 Dave Sexton

References

1. "1979 FA Cup Final" (https://www.bbc.co.uk/manchester/content/articles/2005/04/28/1979_facup_memories_feature.shtml). BBC Manchester. 13 May 2005. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20070830141607/http://www.bbc.co.uk/manchester/content/articles/2005/04/28/1979_facup_memories_feature.shtml) from the original on 30 August 2007. Retrieved 5 September 2007.

2. "What a finish!" (http://www.thefa.com/TheFACup/TheFACup/NewsAndFeatures/Postings/2005/04/FACF_1981_Report.htm). TheFA.com. 20 May 2005. Retrieved 5 September 2007.

External links

- Match Report (<https://web.archive.org/web/20111016194313/http://www.fa-cupfinals.co.uk/1979.htm>)

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